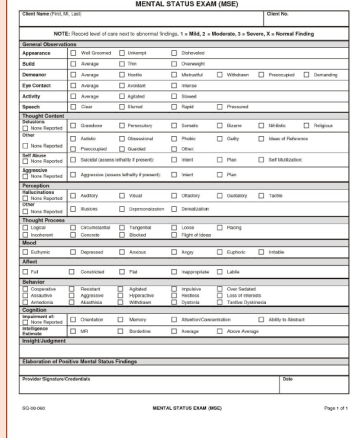


D-6) Assessment/Mental status examination (MSE)

Isolated Clinical Skills Assessment:	Assessment / Mental status examination (MSE)			
ICSA code:	3810_D_6	Version:	1.0	
Date created:	2 May 2023	Course code instructed:	3810MED	
Date revised:	2 May 2023	Course instructed:	Mental Health Conditions in Paramedic Practice	
School:	Medicine	Program:	Paramedicine	
Time limit:	8 minutes			
References:	1. QAS CPP: Assessment/Mental status (Feb 2021) 2. https://www.rch.org.au/clinicalguide/guideline_index/Mental_state_examination/			

No.	Item description:
	Preparation of equipment
1.	Ensures universal precautions (PPE and Dangers).
	Prepare the patient
2.	Correctly identifies the indications for this procedure: ✓ Behavioural abnormalities: ➤ The person's behaviour, including, for example, the way in which the person is communicating, indicates the person is experiencing a disturbance in their mental capacity whether caused by illness, disability, injury, intoxication, or another reason; and ➤ The person appears to require examination or treatment and care, for the disturbance.
	Procedure
3.	Assess the patient appropriately and attempt to ascertain the cause of the presenting signs and symptoms.
4.	Exclude and/or manage causes of abnormal behaviour where possible.
5.	Attempt to treat the patient only if safe to do so.
6.	Using the guide to mental status examination; observe, question and note relevant information. This must be conducted in a highly respectful and empathic manner. Judgemental attitude, interrogatory questioning styles or other disrespectful stances will usually only serve to exacerbate a patient's condition.
7.	Be mindful that different cultures hold different beliefs about mental illness. For some cultures, mental health is determined by physical and/or spiritual influencers. For others, mental illness is a taboo subject and is not discussed openly.
8.	The EEA documentation must record the reasons that results in the ambulance clinician forming the belief that the EEA: ✓ The main objective for meeting the outcome for this clinical practice procedure is to complete the documentation of a case using the PAPER COPY CHECKLIST (either in a simulated or clinical setting) which meets the appropriate standard. - General observations - Thought content - Perception - Thought process - Mood - Affect - Behaviour - Cognition - Insight/Judgement - Elaboration on positive mental status findings
	
9.	Performed within the stipulated time limit.
	END
	Abbreviations: EEA, Emergency Examination Authority.